

Breaktime: helping publishers and bloggers boost advertising revenue with Google Cloud

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ABOUT BREAKTIME

With Google Cloud iKala, Breaktime implemented a digital advertising allocation system that covers browsing behavior of 8 million users across Taiwan, more than a billion ad impressions over 1,300 unique



About Breaktime

Founded in 2017 and headquartered in Taiwan, Breaktime provides data consulting services that help bloggers and publishers generate advertising revenue. The business operates the Zi Media Network and the Zi Power Ads AI advertising allocation system. Through Zi Power Ads AI, Breaktime aims to simplify the use by publishers of “supply-side platforms” to sell digital advertising impressions via automated auctions.

Google Cloud results

- Achieves 99.99%-plus availability
- Supports an average of 10 million page views per day
- Enables analysis of 10,000 blogs and article pages per day

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(<https://www.breaktime.com.tw/>)

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Industries: Professional Services, Technology

Location: Taiwan

[data-studio/](#))

iKala

About iKala

iKala, a Google Cloud Partner, provides AI-driven marketing technology solutions and Google Cloud infrastructure services. With over 40 data scientists and cloud technical specialists on its staff, it helps over 300 enterprises in the Asia Pacific region use Google Cloud to undergo digital transformation and develop applications for artificial intelligence. Its client base covers multiple industries, including ecommerce, media, finance, gaming, and digital advertisements.

IKALA

Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>)

Kubernetes Engine

(<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>)

iKala, a Google Cloud Partner, provides AI-driven marketing technology solutions and

BigQuery (<https://cloud.google.com/bigquery/>)

Looker Studio

(<https://marketingplatform.google.com/about/data-studio/>)

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publishers generate advertising revenue. The business operates the Zi Media Network and the Zi Power Ads AI advertising allocation system. Through Zi Power Ads AI, Breaktime aims to simplify the use by publishers of “supply-side platforms” to sell digital advertising impressions via automated auctions. “We want to help publishers and ‘internet celebrities’ reduce the manual work involved in using supply-

Operations

(<https://cloud.google.com/products/operations>)

for artificial intelligence. Its client base

Cloud Load Balancing

(<https://cloud.google.com/load-balancing/>)

e-commerce, media, finance, gaming, and

Virtual Private Cloud

(<https://cloud.google.com/vpc/>)

Cloud CDN (<https://cloud.google.com/cdn/>)

Vision AI (<https://cloud.google.com/vision/>)

TensorFlow (<https://www.tensorflow.org/>)

side
platforms,
help them
price
advertising
impressions
more
effectively,
and increase
overall
revenue,” says
Joy Shih,
Research
Director at
Breaktime.

Zi Power Ads AI uses data analytics, AI, and machine learning to break down web structures by factors such as content, header, and footer; content structures by title, keywords, publication date, and other elements; ad structures by factors such as ad value, related ads, and ad format; and user structures by factors such as gender, age, interests, behaviors, and devices used. “Through data analysis and machine learning, we can correlate websites and blogs to users, traffic, and ads,” says Shih. “We can identify the best combinations to attract views and click-throughs from desired groups of users.”

Breaktime initially launched Zi Power Ads AI on infrastructure in an internet data center in Taiwan before moving to a cloud infrastructure provider to support fast-increasing traffic volumes. However, reliability and stability issues—including virtual machine shutdowns that stopped Breaktime from

making Zi Power Ads AI available to publishers for extended periods—prompted the business to evaluate other providers.

Google Cloud best fit for requirements

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We are extremely appreciative of the partner’s help.”

—Joy Shih, Research Director, Breaktime

Breaktime compared multinational cloud service providers and found Google Cloud best met its requirements for scalability; managed application containerization; data warehousing, analytics, and visualization; and access to advanced, proven machine learning services. The business engaged Taiwan-based Google Cloud Partner iKala (<https://ikala.tv/>) to provide architecture consultancy services and overviews of Google Cloud services for the migration. “Based on our interactions with iKala, we amended our planned Google Cloud architecture to reduce our internet traffic to one-third the cost we would otherwise incur,” says Shih. “We are extremely appreciative of the partner’s help.”

Breaktime then migrated Zi Power Ads AI to a Google Cloud architecture comprising Google Kubernetes Engine (<https://cloud.google.com/kubernetes-engine/>) to run web applications packaged in Docker container images; BigQuery (<https://cloud.google.com/bigquery/>) for data warehousing and analysis with Looker Studio (<https://lookerstudio.google.com/overview>) providing reports and visualization; and Stackdriver (<https://cloud.google.com/stackdriver/>) to monitor applications and infrastructure. Cloud Load Balancing (<https://cloud.google.com/load-balancing/>)—integrated with the Cloud CDN (<https://cloud.google.com/cdn/>) content delivery network—enables the business to scale its compute resources in line with demand peaks and troughs.

Virtual Private Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/vpc/>)

(VPC) enables Breaktime to secure individual nodes and minimize exposure of its environment to the public internet.

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—Joy Shih, Research
Director, Breaktime

Breaktime also uses TensorFlow—an open source library of machine learning and deep learning models, created by the Google Brain AI research team—to perform natural language processing for content categorization.

A stable environment

“With Google Cloud, we now have a stable environment based on a mature infrastructure,” says Shih.

The Zi Power Ads AI system running on Google Cloud has powered Breaktime into a leadership position in “long tail” advertising—a strategy used by publishers to target a range of niche markets. The system now covers the browsing behavior of about 8 million users across Taiwan, more than 1.6 billion ad impressions, and over 1,300 unique domains. According to Breaktime, businesses that use Zi Power Ads AI increase revenues by an average of 142%.

The Zi Power Ads AI system now supports an average of about 10 million page views and analysis of about 10,000 blog and article pages each day on an infrastructure that delivers more than 99.99% availability.

A leading partner of publishers

“Google Cloud technologies are an extremely good fit for our requirements—with Google, we plan to continue helping publishers and

bloggers
maximize
advertising
returns.”

—Joy Shih, Research
Director, Breaktime

“We are now one of the largest partners of publishers in Taiwan,” says Shih. “As well as helping publishers and bloggers grow revenues, we help them reduce operational costs and lower the barriers to entry into new markets and segments.”

Success with Google Cloud to date has spurred Breaktime to undertake proofs of concept of TensorFlow (<https://www.tensorflow.org/>) machine learning models for picture extraction and Cloud Vision (<https://cloud.google.com/vision/>) to classify and label images. “Google Cloud technologies are an extremely good fit for our requirements—with Google, we plan to continue helping publishers and bloggers maximize advertising returns,” concludes Shih.

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business

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